A Sentence for Someone

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 11

Nib arranged a long row of impressive labels on the blank page. Lark read them and still did not know what the page wanted its reader to do. She moved the labels aside, leaving space for one meaningful sentence chosen by the person making it.

“A sentence with a job,” Nib murmured thoughtfully. “And a reader,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **storybook**

“A sentence tells someone something,” Lark explained warmly. “We begin with a prepared capital, leave spaces between words, and end a statement with a full stop. I can unpack the box is one example, not a message you have to choose. We'll reread your actual words for meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try I, can, unpack, the, box. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Choose, arrange, type, or dictate a message for a real reader,” Lark invited gently. “What should your page tell that person?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can unpack the box. The sheet is on the tray.**

“What can the speaker do?” Lark asked gently. “How is that different from telling us where the sheet is?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The source strip stayed blank until your chosen words were ready. Lark could supply any unprepared spelling and read it back with you. Nib set a clean sheet beside the ink tray and source-plate holder. The station would print the real message rather than award a prewritten sentence as a prize.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write your chosen sentence beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the actual message source with its spaces and full stop. The example stayed available for support. The next outing would test the station at the garden reading place with your own source, paper, and ink.